FAMILY DEVOTIONS FOR THE WEEK

Faith Formation for Families • The Congregation at Prayer • Week of August 30 – September 5, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Invocation

In the name of the Father and of the ✠ Son and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

Introit (see back page)

Memory Verse for the Week — 2 Samuel 7:22

"You are great, O Lord God. For there is none like You, and there is no God besides You, according to all that we have heard with our ears."

Daily Readings: LSB p. 299

Sun: 1 Kings 12:20—13:5, 33–34; 2 Corinthians 8:1–24
Mon: 1 Kings 16:29—17:24; 2 Corinthians 9:1–15
Tue: 1 Kings 18:1–19; Ephesians 1:1–23
Wed: 1 Kings 18:20–40; Ephesians 2:1–22
Thu: 1 Kings 19:1–21; Ephesians 3:1–21
Fri: 2 Kings 2:1–18; Ephesians 4:1–24
Sat: 2 Kings 2:19–25; 4:1–7; Ephesians 4:25—5:14

Talk About It This Week

Each day, read the appointed readings (or just one), then ask: *Where did we hear God's Word planted today? What is God teaching us to trust?* Day-by-day questions for younger and older children are in the daily devotion pages (and on the web page).

In Our Prayers This Week (LSB Daily Prayer Themes)

✠ **Sun:** the joy of the resurrection; fruit of faith in all who heard the Word today
✠ **Mon:** our Baptism, callings, and daily work; schools; good government and peace
✠ **Tues:** deliverance from temptation and evil; the addicted and despairing
✠ **Wed:** marriage and family; parents and children; our home and community
✠ **Thurs:** the Church, pastors, teachers, and missionaries; thanksgiving for the Sacrament
✠ **Fri:** the preaching of the cross; the persecuted; the sick and the dying
✠ **Sat:** faithfulness to the end; hearts made ready for the Lord's Day

Hymn of the Week: ""Come, Follow Me," the Savior Spake" — LSB 688

"Come, follow Me," the Savior spake, / "All in My way abiding; / Deny yourselves, the world forsake, / Obey My call and guiding. / O bear the cross, whate'er betide, / Take My example for your guide."

Apostles' Creed

Lord's Prayer

Benediction

Let us bless the Lord. **Thanks be to God.**

HOW TO USE THIS PAGE… Gather once a day — at breakfast, supper, or bedtime. Speak the Invocation, say the memory verse together, read the day's readings, talk about them, sing the hymn stanza, pray for the day's theme, and close with the Lord's Prayer and Benediction. Ten minutes is plenty. The seed does the work — "so shall My word be… it shall not return to Me empty" (Isaiah 55:11).

The Fourteenth Sunday after Pentecost (Proper 17) August 30, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Introit *Psalm 37:5–7; antiphon: v. 4*

Delight yourself in the LORD,
and he will give you the desires of your heart.
Commit your way to the LORD;
trust in him, and he will act.
He will bring forth your righteousness as the light,
and your justice as the noonday.
Be still before the LORD and wait patiently for him;
fret not yourself over the one who prospers in his way, over the man who carries out evil devices!
Glory be to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit;
as it was in the beginning, is now, and will be forever. Amen.
Delight yourself in the LORD,
and he will give you the desires of your heart.

Collect of the Day

Almighty God, Your Son willingly endured the agony and shame of the cross for our redemption. Grant us courage to take up our cross daily and follow Him wherever He leads; through the same Jesus Christ, our Lord, who lives and reigns with You and the Holy Spirit, one God, now and forever. Amen.

This Sunday's Readings

Jeremiah 15:15–21 · Psalm 26 · Romans 12:9–21 · Matthew 16:21–28

Gradual *Psalm 34:9, 19*

Oh, fear the LORD, you his saints,
for those who fear him have no lack!
Many are the afflictions of the righteous,
but the LORD delivers him out of them all.

Next Sunday's Readings (Proper 18)

Ezekiel 33:7–9 · Psalm 32:1–7 · Romans 13:1–10 · Matthew 18:1–20

Learn by Heart: The Third Petition of the Lord's Prayer *LSB p. 324*

"Thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven. What does this mean? God's good and gracious will is done even without our prayer, but we pray in this petition that it may be done among us also."

THIS WEEK AT HOME: Peter had just confessed that Jesus is the Christ — and moments later he is telling Jesus that the cross must never happen. Jesus answers with the hardest words in the Gospel: "Get behind Me, Satan." Then He turns to all of them and says that following Him means taking up a cross. This week the readings walk with Elijah, a prophet who told the truth when it cost him everything and then wanted to die under a broom tree. Ask one another: "What has following Jesus actually cost anyone in our family — and where has He carried us through it?"

Kids in the Divine Service — What is "making the sign of the cross"?

Making the sign of the cross means to draw an invisible cross on yourself at certain times during prayer and the Divine Service. Hold your thumb and two fingers together; touch your forehead, then your middle, your left shoulder, then your right shoulder, and finally your chest. Try it a few times and it will soon be easy.

Can you think of a time your pastor first made the sign of the cross on you? At your Baptism you received it on your forehead and on your heart to mark you as one redeemed by Christ. This week Jesus says, "Take up your cross and follow Me" — and the cross you were marked with is His, before it is ever yours.

Parents: *Practice making the sign of the cross with your children before or after the service. Remind them we may make it whenever a small red cross appears in the hymnal, or when the pastor makes it over the congregation.*

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